

In the Reaching

By: Lizzie McGlynn

Your song belongs, prolongs, reminds me that beauty is layered.
It does not arrive clean or plain, or simple, or spared.
It grows in the middle of trials and miles,
in the weight of sorrow, the borrowed tomorrows,
in the pain that refuses to fade quietly.

There is a song in the air, rare, light yet restless, unsteady.
It lingers long enough to be felt,
never long enough to be held.
I know myself in that music, intrinsic,
a presence both fragile and strong,
a beauty that matters because it will not stay.

My body does not move the way I wish it could.
Some tasks demand a plan, a span,
between what I imagine and what I can carry out.
Sometimes I resent it, lament it,
other times I wonder if the struggle
makes my joy sharper, brighter, awake.

Your language, ours between us, built from action, reaction,
the way you show up, steady,
the way you fix, protect, provide.
Mine lives in whispered confessions at night,
in holding your hand through crowded streets,
in tracing your face when words fall short.
We stumble, fumble,
not knowing how to translate.
Yet, the reaching matters,
the effort holds us together.

Beauty, then, is not soft,
It is brief, piercing, unsteady.
It grows beside sorrow,
it does not erase it.
To live is to carry both shadow and flame,
to learn again and again,
that even in the reaching,
we are whole, enfolded, and brave.